

THE EXTERIOR

The F-4 Phantom was a very large and robust fighter. Its tough structure came from the aircraft's origins as a carrier fighter, where it had to endure the brutal strains and stresses of catapult launches and arrestor-hook carrier landings. The aircraft's massive undercarriage also stemmed from its carrier beginnings. The rear section of the aircraft was built from titanium and heat-resistant steel to withstand the high temperatures generated by the engine exhausts. The "dogtooth"-shaped leading edge of the wing was added to improve control at high angles of attack. The F-4's J79 turbojet engines were notoriously smoky in flight.

1. "The Gunfighters" badge, featuring "The Spook" Phantom mascot 2. Angle of attack (AOA) sensor 3. Cooling ram air intake 4. Undercarriage leg 5. Ejection seat warning sign 6. Backseater's external rearview mirror 7. Variable air intake ramp 8. USAF roundel showing "stars and bars" 9. Speed brake actuator strut 10. Reinforcement plate 11. Blue navigation light (starboard wing) 12. Wing trailing edge (inner section) 13. Engine bay cooling exit louvers 14. Variable area jet nozzle 15. Tailfin pitot tube 16. Fuel dump mast

